

NOTES

TIMELINE

- **Feed starter:** Feed stiff starter 8–12 hrs before mixing, until domed and just beginning to crack.
- **Mix détrempe:** Soften starter into cold milk first, then combine with everything else. Light-to-moderate gluten development only. Target DDT 68–72°F.
- **Rest & chill:** Flatten, wrap, and chill at least 1 hr (up to overnight).
- **Prepare butter block:** Shape cold butter into a 7×7in (or 7×10in) block inside a folded-parchment mold.
- **Laminate:** Encase the butter (envelope or letter fold), then 3 total fold-equivalents, chilling 30–45 min between every fold.
- **Final rest / freeze:** Chill at least 1 hr, or freeze here if building ahead — holds well up to about a month.
- **Shape, proof, bake:** Roll to ¼in, cut & shape, proof 1.5–3 hrs at 75–80°F, egg wash, bake 400–425°F then 375°F, ~18–22 min total.

Recipe card — Bruce's Breads · Bruce the Bald Baker

◆ FOLD ALONG THIS LINE, TOP PANEL BACK — STANDS LIKE A TENT ◆

Build Block Butter: A Laminated Pastry Dough

Bread & Pastry Flour, laminated with European-style butter — croissants, danishes, pain au chocolat

DOUGH INGREDIENTS

Bread flour	350 g	70%
Pastry flour (or all-purpose)	150 g	30%
Total flour	500 g	100%
Whole milk, cold	225 g	45%
Stiff sourdough starter (45–50% hydration, ripe)	100 g	20%
Sugar	50 g	10%
Fine sea salt	10 g	2%
Unsalted butter, softened (into the dough)	25 g	5%
Instant yeast (optional insurance)	4 g	0.8%
Détrempe total	914 g	

INCLUSIONS

European-style butter (82%+ fat), block	250 g	50% of détrempe flour
Combined détrempe + butter total	1,164 g	

Détrempe + butter block ~1,164 g — enough for roughly 10–12 standard croissants, or a mix of croissants and danishes.

NOTES